

BRD Section: Problem Statement

Background

The proposed service is intended to support UK charities with the grant application process by reducing the effort required to turn information they already hold into clear, funder-ready application content. The current product direction is intentionally focused on grant writing and structuring rather than grant discovery, with discovery and external grant data sources deferred to later phases.[file:21] [file:8] [file:15]

The target users are primarily small and mid-sized UK charities, especially organisations with limited fundraising capacity, where applications are often written by volunteers, generalist staff, or non-specialists rather than dedicated bid writers.[file:2] [file:3] [file:1]

Problem Statement

Small and mid-sized UK charities frequently already possess the core information required for a grant application, such as organisational details, project plans, budgets, outcomes, and beneficiary evidence. However, converting that information into strong, well-structured, funder-specific applications is difficult, repetitive, and time-consuming.[file:8]

Each funder typically asks similar questions in different ways, with different formats, word limits, tone, and evidence expectations. This forces charities to repeatedly rewrite the same material rather than efficiently reusing and adapting it, creating a significant administrative burden on already stretched teams.[file:8]

This burden is especially acute for smaller charities because they often lack dedicated fundraising staff and operate with limited time and specialist expertise. Sector reporting also indicates that small charities continue to face a difficult and unstable funding environment, increasing the pressure to make repeated applications while managing short-term funding cycles.[file:2] [web:27]

The consequence is that valuable staff and volunteer time is diverted away from frontline delivery and organisational development into drafting, redrafting, and quality-checking applications with uncertain outcomes. Indicative sector commentary suggests many trust and foundation applications succeed only around a quarter to two-fifths of the time, with results varying widely depending on funder fit, relationship history, and competitiveness.[web:25] [web:34] [web:26]

Business Need

There is a clear need for a simple, accessible tool that helps UK charities structure, draft, and refine grant applications using information they already have. In its first version, the service should focus on reducing writing effort, improving clarity and consistency, and making it easier for non-specialists to produce stronger applications more quickly.[file:7] [file:8] [file:1]

By addressing the writing and structuring burden first, the service can deliver meaningful value without requiring live grant data integrations or a maintained grant discovery database in v1. This aligns with the current product decisions and creates a practical foundation for future phases that may later add discovery features and links to grant repositories.[file:7]
[file:15][file:19]